

A prayer of a priest, based upon the Epistle of St. Paul to the Colossians.

Lord, I thank Thee, that although I am a terrible sinner and unworthy of the office in which Thou hast placed me, Thou hast placed along my path those whom I am commanded to help in some way.¹

Help me to put aside my lethargy to pray without ceasing for them with sincerity.² I have no confidence in my own poor prayers (except of course when I pray them in front of thy holy altar), but I know that Thou dost command that I pray them. Even if Thou dost not hear the words of an impure man for his flock, hear those of the Holy Ones that I have asked to pray on my behalf, especially Thy most pure Mother and the Holy Great Martyr and Healer Panteleimon.

Grant O Lord, that no matter what I do, and whatever I do not do, those that I encounter may continually bear fruit and increase in the knowledge and grace of Thee, in truth.³

Lord grant that those that I encounter might be filled with the full knowledge of

Thy will in all wisdom and all spiritual understanding⁴ that they might walk worthily of Thee, in everything pleasing, bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the full knowledge of Thee⁵, being strengthened with all power according to the might of Thy glory and all patience and long-suffering with joy⁶ and giving thanks always to thee, the God and Father who renderest us sufficient for the portion of the lot of the saints in the light⁷, who delivered us from the power of darkness and translated us into the Kingdom of Thee, the Son of the love of Thy Father⁸ in whom we have redemption through Thy blood, the forgiveness of sins,⁹ Thou who art the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation.¹⁰

For in Thee were all things created, the things in the heavens and the things upon the earth, the visible and the invisible, whether thrones, or dominions, or principalities, or authorities. All things through Thee and to Thee have been created. And Thou art above all things, and

in Thee all things have come into existence. And Thou art the head of the body, the church; Thou art the beginning, the Firstborn from the dead, that in all things Thou might come to hold first place. For all the fullness was pleased to dwell in Thee; and through Thee to reconcile all things to Thee, having made peace through the blood of Thy cross, through Thee, whether the things on the earth or the things in the heavens.¹¹

Grant, O Lord that all of those whom I know and those whom I do not know, those whom I might help and those whom might try to help and actually hinder, be reconciled in the body of Thy flesh through death, in order to be presented holy and blameless and without reproach before Thee, and that they indeed continue abiding in the faith, firmly founded and steadfast, and are not moved away from the hope of the Gospel which they have heard, which was proclaimed in all creation which is under the heaven of which I am in unworthy minister.¹²

O Lord Thou canst do anything, even with a sinful person. Although I have no

wisdom, grant that when I teach Thy wisdom would help to present every man perfect in Thee, Christ Jesus, whom Thou knowest I labor for, struggling in weakness, and sins, according to the energy of Thee who energizes it in me in power.¹³

Grant that whatever I do, and whatever I do not do, whether it be good or bad, wise or foolish, by Thy grace help them to be knit together in love and unto all wealth of the full assurance understanding, to a full knowledge of the mystery of the God and Father and of Thee, Christ in whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.¹⁴

Help them not to be beguiled by persuasive speech, help them to be steadfast in their faith in Thee.¹⁵

Help them to walk in Thee, to be rooted and built up in Thee and confirmed in the Faith, even as they have been taught, and even as they have not been taught because of my ignorance or my negligence, and abound in the Faith and in the giving of thanks. ¹⁶

Guard them from being led captive through philosophy or vain deceit, according to the traditions of men, according to the elements of the world, and not according to Thee, O Christ.¹⁷

Help them to seek only the things above where Thou, my Christ, is seated at the right of God.¹⁸ Help them to mind only the things above, not the things of earth.¹⁹

By Thy grace, help them to ever remember that in the font they died, and their life is now hidden with Thee, Christ in God, and that whenever Thou, O Christ, Who is our life, should be made manifest that also they shall be manifest with Thee in glory.²⁰

Help all of us therefore to mortify our members which are upon the earth: fornication, uncleanness, passion, evil desire, and covetousness, which is idolatry.²¹ And also these things: wrath, anger, malice, blasphemy, foul language out of our mouths.²²

By Thy grace, help us to cease lying to one another, since we have put off the old man with all of his practices, and put on the

new that is being renewed toward full knowledge according to the image of Thee, the One who hast created us, with there is neither Greek nor Jew, circumcision and circumcision, barbarian, Scythian, slave and free but only Thee, Christ in all things and in all.²³

Help us so Lord, to put on for ourselves as the elect of God, compassion from our inward parts, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, long-suffering, bearing with one another and graciously forgiving one another.²⁴

When anyone of us has a complaint against anyone, even as Thou, our Christ graciously forgave us, thus help us to do.²⁵

And over all these things, help us to put on love which is the bond of perfection and let Thy peace be presiding in our hearts in which we are called into one body, and help us to keep on being thankful.²⁶

Let the word of Thee, our Christ, dwell in us richly in all wisdom, teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual odes, speaking with grace in our heart to Thee, our Lord.²⁷

Help us to be persevering in prayer;
this is so hard for us.²⁸

Help us to walk in wisdom toward
those who are not in the church, redeeming
the time.²⁹

Let our speech always be with grace,
which has been seasoned with salt, to know
how we ought to answer everyone.

And everything, and whatsoever we
may do, in deed or word, help us to do it in
the name of Thee, our Lord Jesus, always
giving thanks to God and Father, through
Thee.³⁰

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-of-a-priest-based-on-colossians.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-of-a-priest-based-on-colossians.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-of-a-priest-based-on-colossians.html>

¹ Col 1:3

² Col 1:3

³ Col 1:6

⁴ Colossians 1:9

⁵ Colossians 1:10

⁶ Colossians 1:11

⁷ Colossians 1:12

⁸ Colossians 1:13

⁹ Colossians 1:14

¹⁰ Colossians 1:15

¹¹ Colossians 1:16 – 20

¹² Colossians 1:21 – 23

¹³ Colossians 1:28 – 29

¹⁴ Colossians 2:2 – 3

¹⁵ Colossians 2:4 – 5

¹⁶ Colossians 2:6 – 7

¹⁷ Colossians 2:8

¹⁸ Colossians 3:1

¹⁹ Colossians 3:2

²⁰ Colossians 3: 3 – 4

²¹ Colossians 3:5

²² Colossians 3:8

²³ Colossians 3:9 – 11

²⁴ Colossians 3:12 – 13 a

²⁵ Colossians 3:13b

²⁶ Colossians 3:14 – 15

²⁷ Colossians 3: 16

²⁸ Colossians 4:2

²⁹ Colossians 4:5

³⁰ Colossians 3:17